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Report Re: Michael David Forbes

NDIS Number: 430771674

I am Michael Forbes therapeutic support going on seven months until the present.

I have been asked to make a report of my work and hours with Michael for an NDIS Plan review by his case manager Jaeme Opie.

I have explained to Jaeme that I interact with Michael maximum four hours per week at present. This consists of up to 3 hours on a Tuesday, with 0.5 travel, because we often go for day trips to Studley park in Fairfield, to Scienceworks in South Melbourne, or to his favourite place, Williamstown.

Michael has complex socio social and 'psychiatric' issues stemming from childhood sexual violence and abuse.

Michael has suffered through his whole life in poverty and this has exacerbated his condition.

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I focus on the more deep, holistic aspects of recovery rather than a DSM, and I do not provide medication nor advice.

What I have been working towards though, is the issue that he with zero affect but great weight bought up with me the first time we met re: the sexual violence.

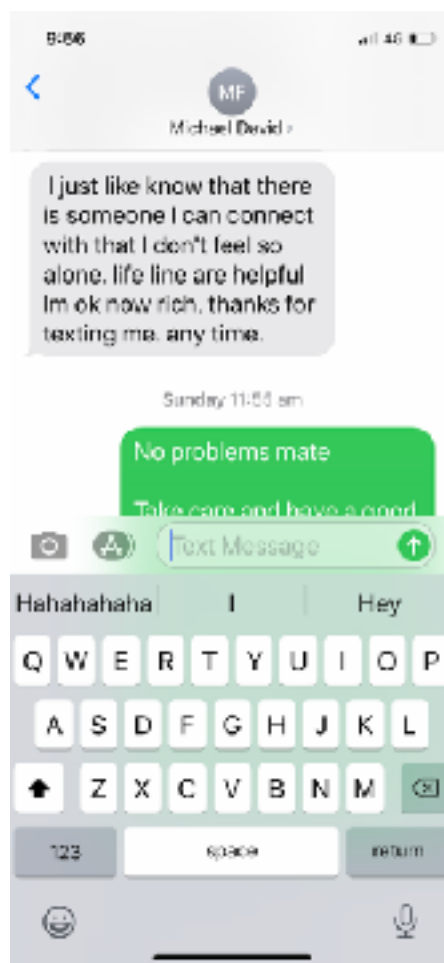
I have attached in this report following a statement made to VOCAT and his psychologist Megan from Healing Minds Psychology to show that it has taken me over seven months to work alongside him co inhabiting and creating in our visual diary in order for me to make a statement to Victims of Crime.

This should demonstrate the many many conversations we have had.

Michaels support network is extremely limited.

He has few friends, or acquaintances he has met through drop in and a community house, and all his family are nearly all passed over.

Michael is especially vulnerable at this time with CORONA and having someone just to take to: see this evidence:



Michael depends heavily on me and he is a likeable person for his humility and kindness.

I go over and beyond for Michael, including sourcing and surprising him with pet rabbits, (which brings much meaning to his life), going around there on my own time when I believe he is at risk of suicide or needs me with the police, or other things like sourcing him a VHS so that he can watch his movies.

I work with Michael anywhere from 2-3 hours on a Tuesday which includes accompanying him to his psychology sessions where we are officially validating and reporting his childhood trauma.

We are aware of some measure of dependency so we have scaled back the sessions to once a week, and I call him on fridays, usually for an hour.

He is very appreciative of the support.

I want to make a recommendation that Michael's current workload with me is 4 hours a week plus travel (4.5 hours).

This is billed at \$193.99 per hour under 'Assessment, Recommendation, Therapy And/Or Training (Incl. AT) - Other Therapy 15_056_0128_1_3', which is the category I bill under.

For Michael to engage with me I would say is essential for at least the next six months to a year.

For this to happen Michael needs $\$193.99 \times 4.5 = \872.95 maximum per week.

I write this with full knowledge of knowing Michael and working to eliminate his trauma of his childhood and co creating in such a way that he has his best possible life.

I will now insert the extensive report I have completed for him for his VOCAT case to demonstrate the long and tedious work to engage with him on his terms and bring the matter not only to acknowledgement and justice, but for his peace of mind and happiness.

Rich Mclean

23/06/2020

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Report Re: Michael David Forbes

NDIS Number: 430771674

I am Michael Forbes therapeutic support going on seven months until the present.

I have been asked to make a statement summarising the many discussions about Michaels sexual abuse by his psychologist Megan Downall from Healing Minds Psychology to support his VOCAT claim. Michaels aim is not only to be acknowledged and believed in a professional and legal way; but to receive compensation for his suffering in his life from the crime.

I will read this to Michael and get him to initial it as it is hard for Michael to confront this all at once. EDIT: yes it was so tough for him to acknowledge this, he was at risk of suicide which is detailed below.

On first meeting Michael, he was dishevelled looking and I was told he had a diagnosis of schizophrenia. However in the first five minutes of meeting him — the reason for his real distress was revealed in honesty and trauma, but with blunt emotional affect. He told me his father has raped him and he was a victim of incest. He had nothing to gain by telling me this and his authenticity for saying so was never in doubt by me.

Over seven months, I tried to get Michael to a psychologist to report his sexual abuse and get help, as I felt it was the main underlying issue of his distress. It took a few times of him cancelling my services before we got to this point because it is so nearly impossible for him to think that this has ruined his whole life. It is no surprise this has been so difficult for Michael.

Among the things he told me over the course of seven months were:

- His father raped him numerous times over two or more years,
- This happened at home on his parents bed, Camping, fishing on a boat, and other places
- His mother was suspicious this was happening and saw Michael and his father on the bed naked. She broke up with him
- It was reported to the police, but the crime was not levered and he was not charged, the purportors mother bailed him out
- Michael told me that he has had many jobs, but he does not know what it is like to 'be a man' and that he has extreme problems relating to men.
- Michael told me he had a girlfriend once, which he 'used to cuddle', (but did not have sex with)
- Michael sexual life is confused and disjointed. He would like a girlfriend but has lost capacity to relate to people.
- He sees people as foreign and cannot trust anyone in life.
- He cancelled my services on more than three occasions — because we were getting close to acknowledging the abuse.
- I was patient with Michael and we re-connected,
- On one occasion, when we were catching up for the last time in Williamstown, Michael wept and cried as he told me, 'You are the only person in the world who has listened to me, not even my mother did.'
- Michael told me that his sister, who died of a drug overdose and was sexually very active over her life, was abused too.
- Michael told me of a horrendous event in which his sister had a miscarriage, and Michael 'Picked it up with a towel and buried it in the back yard.'
- Michael also told me that when they were 6 or 7, his father used to try and get him to have sex with his sister.
- After his fathers death, in which Michael helped to organise the funeral, many people came and were in admiration for him. Michael wanted to stand up and shout what things his father did to him, but reluctantly-he dis not. I find this an incredibly distressing part of his narrative. People were looking at him, because he looked like his father. The level of deceit that had occurred and that the perpetrator had done even after his death to keep the crime(s) silent was extraordinary. Only yesterdays on the 16th June 2020, Michael said 'I'm not like him', however 'he was in me',

both a metaphor for the rape and additionally a reference to their similar looks. Michaels identity over his whole life was ruined by the rapes, and robbed of him by his own father.

- Michael told me that, he used to lie in bed with his sister. I feared the worst, but it does not seem incest or anything sexual was involved-they were simply two victims that needed comfort of each-other. Knowing Michael's father forbade others coming over highlights how extremely sad this part of the narrative is.

- Michael's sister was on drugs her whole life, and his brother was too. Michael recently asked his own brother Rick to make a statement to support his claim but he has refused to talk about it.

- Michael told me that when his sister lived with him, she screamed and he went in and she was covered in blood. She was naked and he noticed 'kind of a baby' covered 'in jelly' on the floor. He told me he consoled his sister and sent her up for a bath. He picked up the miscarriage with a clean tea-towel, and buried it in the back yard. It is extremely distressing to hear these narratives from Michael, and no wonder he is triggered by the life long hell he went through as a direct result of his father's sexual abuse definitively towards Michael, and he says too his sister, and probably brother Rick.

- Michael told me that to cover up the sexual abuse incest and rapes, that the children were forbidden to have any friends around.

- He told me that his father was afraid people would find out, so he acted to shield them and cut them off from friends in childhood.

- Michael told me that the other children were not abused, 'because they were babies.'

- Michael told me after his father's death, he went to his house, and found lots of photos of children, clothed children, but ones that his father had taken and accumulated over the years. Michael reported to me that this was 'creepy' to him.

- Michael told me his brother Rick has possibly suffered this abuse too. Recently he declined to comment or help Michael with his VOCAT claim.

- Michael told me he was penetrated on multiple occasions, 'in the rear' and he knew it was not right because 'it hurt.'

- Michael also has a current strict aversion to being in a shower or being wet with water. This is because his father fondled and played with him in the shower when he was a boy. Michael said 'I did not know what he was doing-how was I to know that was not normal?'

- Michael's siblings apparently lived a life of poverty and drug addiction, which Michael suffered alongside them, and with them. Michael never drank nor did drugs, but his sibling did and police were involved with his family frequently.

- His father also used to demand they did not speak at the dinner table and banned friends that Michael and his siblings could have, to protect this crimes.

- Michael confronted his father in adult life about the rapes and abuse-who continued to turn up at his house year after year still affecting him deeply and psychologically abusing him.
- Michael-in an incredible show of bravery-asked him 'Why did you do that to me?' Michaels father answered that it did not happen and denied any wrongdoing, essentially gaslighting him. Becoming furious, Michael said he was a 'fucking liar,' and asked him firmly again.
- His father replied, 'I was showing you that if you went missing that's what people (other men), would do to you.' His father explained it in the tone of he was being a good parent because he was protecting Michael and showing him what he may endure.

Effect on Michael's Life

- Michael has had terrible trouble regarding all sexual and social relationships with men and women.
- I do not know if he has been very sexually active his whole life. He cannot remember the last time he has had sex.
- Michael says he has had many jobs-and indeed he has-but he could not hold one down because he had troubles relating to men. He feared men, and often was picked on with people misreading his gentle nature for weakness. People can be so cruel.
- Michael says he does not know who he is, and that he does not know what it is like to be a man.
- Michael said to me 'I wonder who I would be if it had not have happened.'
- The effect on his life has devastated it, not only socially and with relationships, but work wise and financially.
- He has suffered the trauma of his siblings and their addictions and cared for the family.
- He has fiercely tried to hold down jobs, with the longest job lasting only a couple of years - and that was because he was working in isolation.
- His sexual relationships over his life, (mature legal adult ones), are seemingly almost non-existent.
- Michael finds it hard to trust anyone, and it took me seven months just to get him to talk about it professionally to a specialised psychologist.
- He has attempted suicide, and he told me of one time he remembers the noose not working.
- Michael has been suicidal many times and extremely isolated. He has been hospitalised multiple times over his lifetime, starting I think in his 30s.

- Whilst he may have appeared as someone having 'schizophrenia,' my job as a holistic listener who validates peoples pain and lives more says that Michael's profound trauma originated in the emotional physical and sexual & emotional abuse and rapes from his father, which destroyed his livelihoods, relationships, and all future employment opportunities. His father destroyed his ideas of his self reflexivity and identity.

- This abuse destroyed life in emotional ways, trust ways, relationship ways, and employment ways. It has rendered him a man who wants to move on but cannot, and indeed sometimes he appears like a six year old in a 51 year olds body.

UPDATE:

- On 15th of June 2020, Michael appeared frustrated and to me felt at risk after he sent me some worrying texts. He was, without me knowing at that point, going to suicide. This is the effect that this abuse has had on his entire life and I am keeping a close eye on him currently and rallying his supports. I called the police to do a welfare check and I could not help but to go in the car with my dog there to his house myself of my own accord. He had attempted suicide before, he tells me. Michael admitted he was planning to suicide - but we negotiated with the police he does not need hospital - just a show of support. I reiterated I would see him at 10am the following morning. The singular reason of this all being brought to light is almost too much for Michael to bear. I am working closely with him in this time to validate his concerns and I have contacted his support worker, the police, and given him resources as well as tending to his house and calling him very frequently.

- Michael is in an extremely vulnerable place with this going to VOCAT and he pendulated from wanting it heard, to rejecting it and getting suicidal.

- I have organised for him to be read this statement to him under the supervision of his psychologist so we can acknowledge his wealth of this terrible story in the safest way possible - and if there is anything he wants changed or omitted we will do that - because this is just so incredibly frustrating and triggering for him.

- I am so proud of Michael and how far he has come. He has the support of his psychologist, myself, the police, and VOCAT and I remind him of his friends, drop in, and his other support worker Kirsty. I highly doubt he has been as candid to anyone to this issue than me-and there is not one second I have counted his memory nor authenticity.

- I plan to call him today 17/06/2020 to check on his welfare again.

- We may need to go at a reconsidered pace with this, although he wants it over and done with.

End report.

RE: This is the body of text for Michael Forbes Statutory Declaration.

Declaration:

My name is Michael David Forbes and over the last seven months I have spoken when I am able and capable about the violent crimes / incest / rapes and abuse to my therapeutic Support worker Rich Mclean. Rich has noted my experiences over that period as a support worker and therapist and has led me to this place today whereby I may able to be believed and compensated for the effect this has had on my life.

As a person I am unable to articulate myself because I have problems writing and it is impossible for me to confront the effect it has had on my life in one session. This is why I have trusted Rich to acknowledge my story in this way, because I simply cannot cope with dealing with it all in a confrontational way in one day.

Rich decided this was the best method to get the story across and recorded.

I wish to state that the above report has been read to me in the presence of Psychologist Megan Downall at Healing Minds psychology on the 30/06/2020 and I wish to state that Rich's summary of my story is true and accurate.

Signed:

Michael David Forbes.

30/06/2020